

Clauses (Embedded Clauses)

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 6 English — Grammar

ACARA v9.0: AC9E6LA05

Learning Intention

I am learning how embedded clauses can expand the variety of complex sentences to elaborate, extend and explain ideas.

Success Criteria

- I can identify an embedded clause in a sentence.
- I can explain what extra information an embedded clause adds.
- I can add an embedded clause to my own sentence.

Extra Info, Tucked Inside

An embedded clause sits inside another clause, often between commas, adding extra detail without needing a new sentence: The dog, which was very muddy, ran inside.

Worked Example

Simple: The house was old. It had a red door.

Embedded: The house, which had a red door, was old.

Part A — Warm Up

Circle the embedded clause: *My dog, **who loves the beach**, barked loudly.*

True or False: An embedded clause always adds extra detail about the noun before it.

Name a word often used to start an embedded clause (e.g. who, which).

Part B — Core Skills

Combine using an embedded clause: *The book was fascinating. It was written by a local author.*

Identify the embedded clause: *The bridge, which was built in 1900, is still standing.*

Add an embedded clause to: *The teacher praised the student.*

Explain what extra information the embedded clause adds in: 'My uncle, who is a pilot, travels often.'

Word Bank

embedded clause • independent clause • who • which • that • extra detail • elaborate • extend

Working Space — Write 2 Sentences Using an Embedded Clause

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Part C — Challenge: The Museum Exhibit Description

A Year 6 student wrote a museum caption: "The fossil, which was discovered near Geelong, is over 10,000 years old."

- Q8. Identify the embedded clause in the caption and explain what extra information it adds.
- Q9. Rewrite the caption as two separate simple sentences instead of using an embedded clause.
- Q10. Explain why a museum writer might prefer the embedded clause version over two separate simple sentences.

Answer Key — Part A

A1: "who loves the beach" is the embedded clause.

A2: True — an embedded clause typically adds extra detail about the noun that comes just before it.

A3: who (accept which, that).

Answer Key — Part B

B1: The book, which was written by a local author, was fascinating.

B2: "which was built in 1900" is the embedded clause.

B3: Any correct sentence adding an embedded clause (e.g. "The teacher, who was very proud, praised the student.") — teacher to check.

B4: It adds extra detail about the uncle's job, telling the reader he is a pilot, without needing a separate sentence.

Answer Key — Part C

C8: "which was discovered near Geelong" — it adds extra detail about where the fossil was found.

C9: The fossil was discovered near Geelong. It is over 10,000 years old.

C10: The embedded clause keeps both pieces of information smoothly connected in one sentence, making the caption flow better and read more like professional museum writing than two short, separate sentences.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can identify embedded clauses.

☐ I can add my own embedded clause.

☐ I can explain what they add to a sentence.